



### Decoding geometry of Viruses

Researchers believe mathematical insights on how RNA works with protein shells could help create better vaccines. <http://digit.in/VirusMath>



### Razer's gaming smartphone

Razer is looking to raise as much as \$5 billion through an IPO, for the resources needed to make smartphones. <http://digit.in/Razerphone>

# All your pop culture stories are stolen

Star Wars? Check.  
Lion King? Check.  
LOTR? Double check.

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**C**harles Caleb Colton once said, 'Imitation is the sincerest form of flattery'. While that might be true, getting credit for it (and royalties) would sure make the flattery a bit sweeter for the original creators. These are ideas that were 'taken inspiration' from to make stories that went on to become some of the most successful franchises of their (or even all) time. While we are not implying that this decreases the greatness of these franchises in any way, but an official nod to acknowledge the effort behind the original creation would be nice. Nonetheless, today we talk about some such 'cases' of inspiration that were later identified, either officially by the inspired author or unofficially by the fans in general.

## STAR WARS - VALERIAN AND LAURELINE

Recently released movie 'Valerian and the City of a Thousand Planets' is based on the french science fiction comic series 'Valerian and Laureline'.

What people may not know is that there is a widely accepted opinion that Valerian was a huge inspiration behind a lot of stuff in Star Wars.

Now we're not implying that the epic story from 'a galaxy far far away' was entirely borrowed or ripped off in any way, but there are quite a few similarities that are undeniable. While there are no mentions of Valerian anywhere in any Star Wars text or other media, Writer Pierre Christin and artist Jean-Claude Mézières' – and the fans of the french series – have no doubt about the role it played in the development of the epic saga. As comic book publisher Kim Thompson puts it, "In 1977 Mézières sat down in a movie theatre to enjoy a new movie called Star Wars and was astonished to see how many of the designs and concepts — and, indeed, the whole motif of a lived-in, funky



"Funny to see you here!", says Leia, to which Laureline responds: "Oh, we've been coming to this club for a long time!"

future — seemed awfully familiar," Thompson wrote, "Polite inquiries to the Lucas camp went unanswered, but over the years word leaked back that the Star Wars designers (some of them French) had indeed maintained a nice collection of Valerian albums."

Iconic elements like Princess Leia's slave bikini, the Millennium Falcon, the unmasking of Darth Vader to reveal a grotesque disfigured face, a clone army, Han Solo in carbonite, you'll find their counterparts around 4-5 years prior in Valerian comics. Creator Mézières wasn't exactly amused.



Welcome to Allobol - 1972



Star Wars - 1977



The Land Without Stars - 1972



Return of the Jedi - 1983



The Empire of a Thousand Planets - 1971



The Empire Strikes Back - 1980



The Empire of a Thousand Planets - 1971



Revenge of the Sith - 2005



The Empire of a Thousand Planets - 1971



Revenge of the Sith - 2005



Ambassador of the Shadows - 1975



The Phantom Menace - 2001